

VM Import

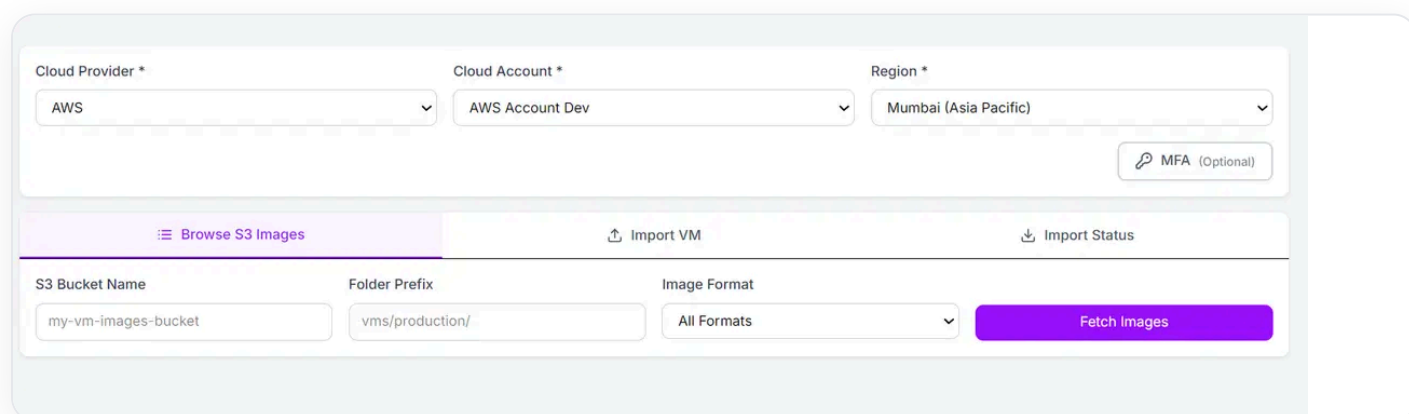
VM Import lets you bring virtual machine images stored in an S3 bucket directly into your cloud account as importable AMIs. Whether the image was exported by QuickInfra or uploaded manually, this section handles the full import workflow — browse, select, import, and track status.

What is VM Import?

VM Import is the counterpart to VM Export. When you export a virtual machine image to S3 — either through QuickInfra's export feature or manually from any source — VM Import gives you a streamlined way to bring that image back into your cloud account as a usable AMI.

This is the mechanism that enables true cloud portability. You can export a VM from one provider or account, store it in S3 as a neutral format, and then import it into any AWS account in any region — effectively moving workloads across environments without the need to reprovision or reconfigure from scratch.

Note: VM Import works with images exported by QuickInfra as well as any VM image you have manually uploaded to S3 in a supported format — VMDK, VHD, VHDX, or OVA.



The screenshot shows the VM Import interface. At the top, there are three dropdown menus for 'Cloud Provider *' (set to AWS), 'Cloud Account *' (set to AWS Account Dev), and 'Region *' (set to Mumbai (Asia Pacific)). To the right of these is an 'MFA (Optional)' button. Below these is a navigation bar with three tabs: 'Browse S3 Images' (active), 'Import VM', and 'Import Status'. Under the 'Browse S3 Images' tab, there are three input fields: 'S3 Bucket Name' (my-vm-images-bucket), 'Folder Prefix' (vms/production/), and 'Image Format' (All Formats). To the right of these fields is a purple 'Fetch Images' button.

The VM Import screen — browse your S3 bucket for VM images, select one, and import it directly into your cloud account.

How to Import a VM

1 Navigate to Manage → VM Import

From the left sidebar select **Manage** then **VM Import**. Select your **Cloud Provider**, **Cloud Account**, and **Region** — this is the target account and region where the imported AMI will be created.

2 Browse S3 Images

On the **Browse S3 Images** tab, enter your **S3 Bucket Name** where the VM image is stored. Optionally provide a **Folder Prefix** to narrow the search to a specific path within the bucket — for example *vms/production/*. Select an **Image Format** or leave it as All Formats, then click **Fetch Images** to list all available VM images in that location.

3 Select and Import

From the list of images returned, select the one you want to import and switch to the **Import VM** tab. Configure any import settings required — such as the target architecture and OS type — then submit the import job.

4 Track Import Status

Switch to the **Import Status** tab to monitor the progress of your import job. VM imports can take several minutes depending on the image size. Once complete, the imported image appears in your **VM Images** section as an available AMI ready for use in deployments.

✔ **Tip:** If you exported the VM using QuickInfra's VM Export feature, the image is already in the correct format and folder structure in S3. Simply point VM Import at the same bucket and prefix to find it immediately.

⚠ **Warning:** Ensure the S3 bucket is in the same AWS region as the target cloud account, or that cross-region access is correctly configured. Import jobs will fail if the service cannot access the S3 object due to bucket policy or region restrictions.

Supported Image Formats

VMDK — VMware Virtual Machine Disk, commonly exported from VMware vSphere or Workstation.

VHD / VHDX — Microsoft Virtual Hard Disk formats, typically from Hyper-V or Azure.

OVA — Open Virtualization Archive, a portable format supported by most hypervisors.

Key Things to Know

The S3 bucket must be accessible from the target AWS account — ensure the bucket policy grants the necessary permissions to the AWS VM Import service role.

Import jobs are asynchronous — the Import Status tab is your source of truth for progress and any error messages.

Once imported, the AMI behaves identically to any other AMI in your account and can be used to launch instances via Infrastructure Projects.

Large images (100GB+) may take 30–60 minutes to import — plan accordingly when scheduling migrations.